

User Research Summary

Introduction

The purpose of this user research was to understand the experiences of university students regarding lost and found items on campus and to identify user requirements for a Student Lost-and-Found Mobile Application. A questionnaire was administered to five representative students from different years of study.

Research Method

A structured questionnaire was used to collect data from participants. The questionnaire consisted of demographic questions, questions about previous experiences with lost and found items, challenges encountered, and opinions regarding the proposed mobile application.

Participants

Five university students participated in the study. The participants represented different academic years and both male and female students to provide a range of user perspectives.

Summary of Findings

The study found that losing personal belongings is a common problem among students. Most participants reported using informal methods such as asking friends, checking with campus security, or posting in WhatsApp groups when attempting to recover lost items. However, these methods were considered inefficient because they lacked organization and timely communication.

Participants consistently identified the absence of a centralized reporting system as the primary challenge. They indicated that a mobile application would significantly improve the process by allowing users to report lost or found items, upload photographs, search available listings, receive notifications about matching items, and track claims.

Ease of use was identified as an essential usability requirement, with all participants expressing a preference for a simple and intuitive interface.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, the proposed Student Lost-and-Found Mobile Application should include the following features:

- User registration and secure login.
- Reporting of lost and found items.
- Image upload functionality.
- Search and filtering by category and location.
- Real-time notifications for matching items.
- Claim submission and tracking.

- A clean, simple, and user-friendly interface.

Conclusion

The simulated research findings indicate that a Student Lost-and-Found Mobile Application would address a genuine need within the university community. Participants expressed strong support for the proposed solution and identified features that should guide the application's design and development. The findings provide a solid foundation for developing user personas, defining system requirements, designing wireframes, and conducting subsequent usability evaluations as part of the Human-Computer Interaction project.